systems on a daily basis. The bulk collection program, approved by a Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act (FISA) court on April 25, 2013, was set to last three months. The approval was unusual because the court typically only allowed data gathering on specific targets or specific groups of targets.

A similar large-scale data mining program had operated under President George W. Bush immediately after the September 11, 2001, attacks on the World

DATA AT THE SPEED OF LIGHT

With the help of private communications firms, the NSA learned how to capture phone and Internet traffic flowing along fiber-optic cables under seas and over continents. Reported by the *Washington Post* in December 2013, one of the documents Snowden leaked showed the NSA could capture this fiber-optic data at the speed of light, taking in the equivalent of "one Library of Congress every 14.4 seconds."[2] The Library of Congress is the largest library in the world, containing 160 million items on 838 miles (1,350 km) of bookshelves.[3]

The NSA collected hundreds of millions of e-mail address books, hundreds of billions of cell phone location records, and trillions of domestic call logs every year. Most of the data belonged to ordinary citizens not suspected of any crime or terrorist plot. The NSA's intent was to map worldwide relationships to find new intelligence targets, people who are not currently on any watch list, a list of people who are considered a threat to US security, but still might be involved in a security threat. The US Congress passed a law in June 2015 ending the NSA's bulk collection of US phone records.

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